

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 5 4 2

♥ 5 4

♦ K Q 4 3

♣ 9 6 5

♠ K 9 6 3

♥ A 7

♦ J 10 9

♣ A J 10 7



♠ 8

♥ J 10 6 3 2

♦ A 8 5

♣ 8 4 3 2

♠ Q J 10 7

♥ K Q 9 8

♦ 7 6 2

♣ K Q

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♣

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Lead: ♣ 3

When you have two 4-card suits to show you bid them "up-the-line". In this case it means you say 1 ♥. Partner replies 1 ♠.

There are enough points for game and a known 8-card Major fit. So you bid 4 ♠.

Perfect bidding isn't always rewarded. They can win three ♦ tricks and the Ace of trumps. If the opening lead is a ♥ or a ♣ you might make it, so it just depends on luck.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 10 4
 ♥ J 9 7
 ♦ A K 7 2
 ♣ K 5 3

♠ Q 6 2
 ♥ Q 4 2
 ♦ 4 3
 ♣ Q J 10 8 7



♠ A J 5
 ♥ K 10 6
 ♦ Q 9 8 6
 ♣ A 9 6

♠ 9 8 7 3
 ♥ A 8 5 3
 ♦ J 10 5
 ♣ 4 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1 ♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♠ 8			

You have two very good choices, neither of which is really wrong. You could bid 2NT, showing 13-16 points, balanced, or you could bid 3♦, showing 13-16 points, good trump support.

What should decide you is the bidding priorities. You'd much rather try to play a 9-trick game than an 11-trick game. And at the same time you must trust your partner not to leave you hung out in Notrump with an unsuitable hand. (Can you believe I wrote Notrump and unsuitable in the same sentence?)

Anyway, you bid 2NT and partner raises to 3NT.

Board 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 6
♥ A 8
♦ 10 9 8 5 4
♣ 10 9 7 4

♠ A K 9 2
♥ J 5
♦ K 7 2
♣ K 8 3 2



♠ J 7 5 4
♥ 9 7 4 3 2
♦ J 3
♣ A 6

♠ 10 8 3
♥ K Q 10 6
♦ A Q 6
♣ Q J 5

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♦ 9			

With 14 points and a 4-3-3-3 distribution this could be the perfect hand for a jump to 2NT. But not when the 4-card suit is a Major - you should not skip bidding a Major when you have the opportunity.

So you respond 1 ♥. Partner says 1 ♠.

Partner doesn't have 4 ♥s so you go back to thinking this is an ideal notrump hand. So ideal that you apply the "She who knows, goes" principle and bid 3NT. Partner smiles and passes.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 10 9 3
♥ A 10 8 4
♦ Q 10 3
♣ A 9

♠ 8 5 4 2
♥ Q 7 5 3
♦ A 5 2
♣ 6 3



♠ A 7
♥ K 9
♦ K J 9 7 4
♣ J 10 8 5

♠ Q J 6
♥ J 6 2
♦ 8 6
♣ K Q 7 4 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	3 ♦	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♥3			

You have great ♦ support and perhaps 15 points. The "perhaps" is because partner may have only 3 ♦s, and if you are the long-trump hand any ruffs you take will probably not increase the number of trump tricks your side makes. But still, you have a great hand.

So you bid 3 ♦. Partner now says 3NT.

You described your hand very well with your first bid. Partner heard the description and chose 3NT. Since you trust your partner you pass.